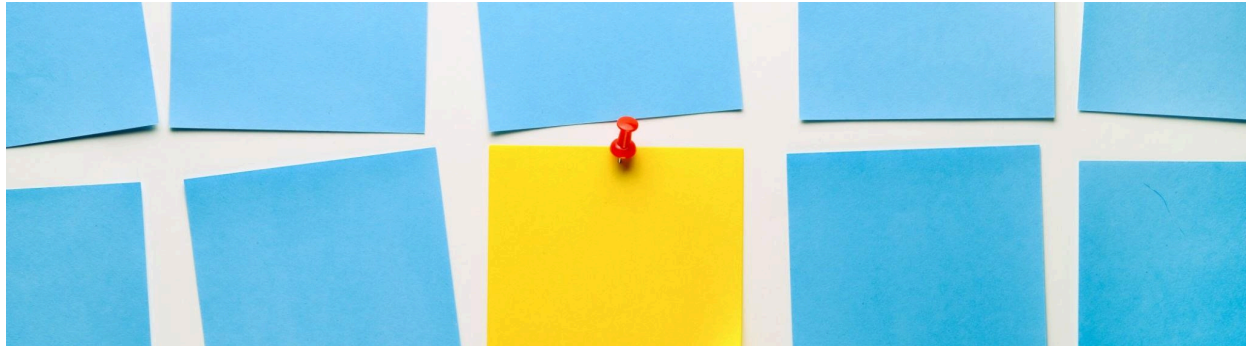




# Gamers Lab Developer Pitch Guide

Status **In progress** ▾

Timing 📅 Date to 📅 Date

Owners 👤 Person

## Overview

Provide a high-level summary of the Gamers Lab project to game developers and game studios. It addresses two subtypes of Games, established projects and upcoming releases.

# Target Game Subtypes

## Established Games

Studios with a released, live-service or long-tail game that has passed its peak CCU and revenue period. These games have an existing, loyal playerbase but are experiencing natural decline in daily active users, Steam sentiment, or DLC sales velocity.

The studio is typically running lean on live ops and is not actively investing in major new features.

**Core Pitch:** Revitalization with a data-layer UGC that gives the community the tools to pull lapsed players back, rebuild CCU health, and extend the commercial life of the game without requiring significant engineering investment from the studio.

## New / Upcoming Games

Studios with a game in development or early access that has not yet reached its full launch or peak audience. These teams are heads-down on the game itself and typically under-resourced for community tooling and ecosystem development.

**Core Pitch:** Launch amplification. Integrating before launch means the game goes live with official data infrastructure already in place. This enables community members and builders to create leaderboards, stat trackers, and companion apps from day one, accelerating early retention and signaling to players that the studio is community-forward.

|             | Established Games                                                | New / Upcoming Games                      |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Core Fear   | Irreversible decline                                             | Bad launch / early churn                  |
| Core Desire | Extend the game's life                                           | Build momentum from day one               |
| Hook        | Your best players haven't left / give them a reason to come back | Launch with an ecosystem, not just a game |

|                     |                                                        |                                               |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Key Metric</b>   | CCU resurrection, Steam sentiment, DLC sales           | Day-30 retention, early community engagement  |
| <b>Risk Framing</b> | You've already taken the big risks. This one is small. | Set the terms before you lose control of them |

## Objection Map

| Objection                                                                                                                     | Response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>"We don't want to share private data"</p> <p>"We're worried about competitive intelligence, rivals could see our data"</p> | <p><b>You control exactly what's shared</b>, per field, per audience, with delays and redaction.</p> <p>Users can additionally control their own amount of privacy (similar to steam).</p> <p>Nothing is public unless you make it public.</p> <p>We will work with you hand in hand to develop the appropriate shared data policy.</p> |
| "We don't want another dependency"                                                                                            | <p><b>Data writes out from your server or game. If we go down, your game keeps running.</b></p> <p>Gamers Lab runs on typical REST API calls.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| "We'd have to build an integration"                                                                                           | <p>Beyond login, game start, all of the data is structured "key/value pairs" such as "kill / person name".</p> <p>Its sent by REST API.</p> <p><b>Most likely you are already exposing this to the game UI or other places already. It's just a matter of capturing it.</b></p> <p>Typical integration time is 2 - 3 afternoons.</p>    |
| "There's no ecosystem yet"                                                                                                    | You're not joining an ecosystem, you're founding one for your game.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

|                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                        | <p>Early partners get influence over the platform roadmap.</p> <p>Gamers Lab is seeding the ecosystem themselves and with key partners. We can work together to throw events or build the apps that will drive value for you.</p> <p>Building UGC apps with your community together<br/>IS THE ENGAGEMENT YOU WANT</p> <p><b>Frame &gt;&gt; First movers not unproven ecosystem</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| "UGC are mods and security risks"                                      | <p><b>This is data OUT. No new attack surface.</b></p> <p>User Generated Content is built in separate applications that use game data, but not inside your game itself.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| "What if someone misuses our data or violates our IP?"                 | <p>Think of it like running your own Twitter/X API program. You decide who gets access, under what terms, and you can pull access at any time.</p> <p><b>All data is provided "as is" without any "IP Transfer" or usage rights, with "No Warranty".</b></p> <p>Some studios will have open public API keys access. "You can use our data but not our IP or endorsement"</p> <p>Others will require builders to apply and get approved. This still doesn't need to imply warranty, but <b>allows studios maximum control</b>.</p> <p>Your data policy is yours to set and yours to change.</p> |
| "Our players are declining, so app builders won't care about our game" | <p>App builders want to build where players already exist, not where they might exist one day. An established game with 50k monthly actives is more attractive to a builder than a promising new game with 500.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

# Pitch Notes

**What I'd caution against:** Don't over-index on the AI angle in developer-facing messaging. Let it be a subtle proof point ("tools can be built faster, by more people, without your team's involvement") rather than a headline.

Many gamer developers are NOT excited about AI. The headline should be about control, safety, and zero lift relative to value.

## Production Positioning

Premium / Free to Play

### Eric's Notes, Possible Pitch Angles

- **UGC App Layer**
  - Gamers Lab gives your game the retention benefits of UGC without the security risk — data out only, community in, nothing touching your game.
  - Games with UGC ecosystems retain players 75% longer. Gamers Lab gets you there without mods, without engine risk, and without your team building anything.
- **Ecosystem**
  - Gamers Lab lets your community build the companion apps, stat trackers, and tournament tools your game deserves
  - Join the expanding community of applications
- **Data API**
  - Turns your game into a data API
  - Gamers Lab gives your game an official data API program so your community can build on it
- **Trust Layer**
  - Permissioned Immutable Data Layer
  - A layer of trusted information (more important with real money involved, prizes and competitive play) ← competitive play angle
- **Two sided marketplace**

- Two-sided marketplace connecting game studios who want a developer ecosystem with app builders

## Als Targets

### UGC App Layer

- Live ops / community managers — they own retention metrics and feel the CCU decline daily
- Indie to mid-size studio founders — big enough to care about retention, lean enough to want a low-lift solution
- Established games in visible decline — the 75% stat hits hardest when you can see your own numbers slipping
- Studios who've watched a competitor's community ecosystem outperform them

### Ecosystem

- Studio marketing and community leads — they think in touchpoints, engagement, and community growth
- Studios that already have an active Discord or content creator community but no official tools to support them
- New/upcoming games wanting to launch with momentum and community investment from day one

### Data API

- Engineers and technical leads — they immediately understand what an API program means and respect the precision
- Studios who have already thought about building their own API but haven't prioritised it
- Developer-facing conferences and technical pitch contexts

### Trust Layer

- Esports and tournament organisers — they need verified, disputed-proof match results
- Studios with competitive ranked modes or prize-based play
- Studios exploring real-money tournaments, wagering, or prize pools
- Legal and business affairs contacts at larger studios who care about auditability
- Web3 adjacent studios where on-chain settlement requires trusted off-chain data

## Two-sided Marketplace

- Investors and VCs — they understand marketplace dynamics and network effects immediately
- Accelerators and pitch competitions
- Business development partners evaluating the platform commercially

# FAQs

## **Q: Do you help find app developers for the ecosystem?**

A: Yes. For first movers we offer assistance in finding app developers, as well as access to the app ecosystem we are currently building. Gamers Lab and its partners are actively seeding the ecosystem with apps.

As an early partner, you have the opportunity to influence the core development direction of those apps, as well as participate in UGC app-building hackathons sponsored by Gamers Lab.

## **Q: What apps already exist?**

A: (Coming soon)

## **Q: Why would people build UGC apps on top of our game?**

A: Many people build UGC apps simply because they love the game or enjoy the challenge of creating something new.

Beyond passion projects, UGC app developers can monetize their apps, making it a sustainable and increasingly professional pursuit.

## **Q: Do I get paid when people use my data?**

A: No. Games benefit from sharing their data by building a larger ecosystem with more touchpoints to their product, driving retention, re-engagement, and community growth.

If you want to set your own commercial terms for data access outside the public program, we offer a paid white label service.

**Q: Can I use Gamers Lab but only issue read keys to myself (no public access)?**

A: Not under the free program.

Gamers Lab requires that participants share at least some of their game data with UGC builders. You remain in full control of what data is shared and who gets access, but fully private use is not supported here.

If that's what you need, our paid white label service lets you set your own terms.

**Q: Is there any cost to using Gamers Lab?**

A: No. Gamers Lab is completely free for video games and game studios. Costs are borne by the UGC app developer side.

**Q: Are the UGC apps people build free to use?**

A: Pricing for UGC apps is set by the developers who build them. They may be free or paid products. In our experience, most developers lean toward a free, ad-supported model with optional upsells.

**Q: How do UGC app builders earn revenue?**

A: UGC app builders can earn revenue through game-focused partner ads displayed within their apps, or opt for a direct model by paying a small fee to Gamers Lab to consume the data instead.

**Q: I don't want ads inside my game.**

A: UGC apps are independent products that consume your game data, they are not embedded inside your game.

No ads are ever displayed within your game itself.

**Q: Can my older game's data be used to promote an upcoming game?**

A: Yes. Every time a UGC app developer requests access to your data, they apply for an API key giving you visibility into who they are and their contact details, so you can engage with them directly.

Gamers Lab also actively helps early adopters form partnerships between game studios and app builders, and our own developed apps have room for specific promotional placements.

## Studio Pitch Ladder

**The order matters.**

1. **What it does:** Expose your game data, on your terms and creates a universal game API for your game
2. **Why it matters to you:** Attract UGC app builders to your game (followed by the stat block as proof)
3. **Why its Safe:** Safe by design — data only flows out (disarm risk)
4. **Disarm largest concern:** You control every permission, only expose what you want.
5. **Cost and Risk.** Two or three afternoons to integrate, free solution to use.

*UGC-supported games do not just monetize better — they retain attention longer. In the 2025 mod.io / GameDiscoverCo study, games with official UGC support showed an 8% revenue advantage after year one and 31% after five years, while maintaining 75% higher CCU after two years and 115% higher CCU after five years.*

### **UGC Impact Over Time**

**+8%** revenue after Year 1  
**+31%** revenue after Year 5  
**+75%** CCU after Year 2  
**+115%** CCU after Year 5

# Studio vs App Builder Personas

## Persona 1: The Studio

**Who they are:** Mid-level decision-maker at a game studio — could be a CTO, technical director, head of platform, or a senior producer. They have authority to greenlight an integration but they answer to people above them if it goes wrong.

**Their relationship to their game:** Deep. The game is a years-long investment of money, headcount, and personal reputation. Every decision about it gets weighed against the question "*could this be the thing that breaks something?*" They are not playful about new platforms.

### The two questions on their mind:

1. **Is my data safe? Is my game safe?** They want to know what surface area they're exposing, who can touch what, and how quickly they can pull the plug if something goes wrong. They assume the worst-case scenario by default.
2. **What technical debt will this create?** Integrations rot. Partner APIs require maintenance. SDK upgrades break things. They want to know the long-term cost, not just the day-one cost.

**Their disposition:** Skeptical, risk-averse, slow to integrate. They have been pitched many platforms. Most of those platforms didn't survive. They have learned to wait.

**What converts them:** Concrete reassurance, not enthusiasm. Specific permission models. Named studios who've already integrated. Honest time estimates. Evidence the team will exist in two years. They are persuaded by *the absence of red flags*, not by promises of upside.

**What loses them:** Buzzwords. Hype. Claims that sound too good. Marketing copy that doesn't address risk. CTAs that feel pushy. Anything that smells like a startup that hasn't thought about edge cases.

**How marketing should talk to them:** Lead with what they keep, not what they get. Show control before benefit. Use specific, technical language. Cite real numbers. Acknowledge tradeoffs. Treat them as the smartest person in the room, because in their organization, they often are.

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## Persona 2: The Builder

**Who they are:** A developer, designer, or technical hobbyist. Could be a solo indie maker, a Twitch streamer who codes, a community moderator with technical chops, a student, a small team building tools. Skill levels range widely. Some are professionals; many are not.

**Their relationship to games:** Player first, builder second. They love games but they don't own one. They're not protecting anything — they're looking for something to make.

### The two questions on their mind:

1. **What can I build?** They want to know the canvas. What kinds of apps are possible. What data they get. What platforms they can deploy to. They're imagining the project before they've signed up.
2. **Why bother?** They want to know the upside. Is there a real audience for what they make? Can they earn from it? Will their work reach players, or sit unused? Time is their main resource and they're protective of it.

**Their disposition:** Curious, not skeptical. They want to be convinced — they're already half-sold by the existence of a platform that lets them build. The barrier isn't suspicion; it's friction.

**What converts them:** A clear sense of what's possible. Examples of what others have built. Low time-to-first-build. AI tooling that lowers the skill floor. A free tier so they can start without commitment. Evidence that their app could reach real players.

**What loses them:** Long onboarding. Restricted app types. Approval queues. Vague monetization. Documentation that assumes they're already an expert. Anything that signals "you need permission to build here."

**How marketing should talk to them:** Lead with the canvas. Show the variety of things people are making. Make signup feel close (free, fast, no approval). Emphasize accessibility — AI-native tools, MCP, CLI — so the message reaches non-traditional builders too. Treat them as creative, capable, and ready to go. Don't waste their time with reassurance they didn't ask for.